

January 30, 2026

Representative Amy Walen
Chair, House Consumer Protection
and Business Committee
437B Legislative Building
PO Box 40600
Olympia, WA 98504

Representative David Hackney
Vice Chair, House Consumer Protection
and Business Committee
330 John L. O'Brien Building
PO Box 40600
Olympia, WA 98504

Representative Shelley Kloba
132A Legislative Building
PO Box 40600
Olympia, WA 98504

RE: Letter in Opposition to Washington HB 2483

Dear Chair Walen, Vice Chair Hackney, and Representative Kloba:

On behalf of the advertising industry, we write to oppose Washington HB 2483.¹ We provide this letter to offer our non-exhaustive list of concerns about this bill. HB 2483 would create new registration requirements for data brokers and establish new rulemaking authority within the Department of Licensing. Accordingly, we ask you to decline to advance the bill as drafted out of the House Consumer Protection and Business Committee (“Committee”).

As the nation’s leading advertising and marketing trade associations, we collectively represent thousands of companies across the country. These companies range from small businesses to household brands, advertising agencies, and technology providers. Our combined membership includes more than 2,000 companies that power the commercial Internet, which accounted for nearly 20 percent of total U.S. gross domestic product (“GDP”) in 2024.² By one estimate, approximately 18.6% of Washington jobs in 2024 were related to the ad-subsidized Internet, a share projected to increase to 20.0% by 2029.³ Our group has more than a decade’s worth of hands-on experience it can bring to bear on matters related to consumer privacy and controls. We would welcome the opportunity to engage with the Committee further on the points we discuss in this letter.

¹ Washington HB 2483 (2025-26 Session), located [here](#) (hereinafter, “HB 2483”).

² S&P Global, THE ECONOMIC IMPACT OF ADVERTISING ON THE US ECONOMY, 2024-2029 at 4 (Aug. 2025), located at https://theadcoalition.com/wp-content/uploads/2025/08/TAC_SP-Global-Final-Report_August-2025.pdf.

³ *Id.* at 15-16.

I. HB 2483 would create a data broker registry that is largely duplicative of existing disclosures and, if enacted, should be harmonized with other privacy laws.

The registry requirements in HB 2483 mandate that data brokers annually register with the Department of Licensing and disclose information about their business practices, including the types of personal data they collect, how it is processed, security measures, and opt-out processes.⁴ This information is already routinely disclosed by data brokers through their privacy policies and compliance mechanisms under other existing state privacy laws, which similarly require public transparency about data collection, sale, and consumer rights. If the Legislature chooses to establish a data broker registry, we encourage the Committee to harmonize HB 2483's requirements with existing state approaches to ensure consistency for businesses operating nationally and to reduce the need for duplicative disclosures, while still achieving transparency goals for consumers.

II. HB 2483 establishes new rulemaking, which is unnecessary and risks further fragmentation.

HB 2483 authorizes the Department of Licensing to adopt rules “necessary to implement the provisions of this chapter.”⁵ HB 2483 already outlines detailed registration disclosures, including specific information (e.g., security practices, opt-out mechanisms) that must be reported annually, so the value of additional agency rulemaking authority is unclear. Allowing broad rulemaking could lead to new definitions, registry requirements, or compliance mandates not vetted by the Washington State Legislature, creating uncertainty for businesses and consumers, and potentially conflicting with other state privacy frameworks. We encourage the Committee to remove this rulemaking authority and ensure the legislative language aligns with the majority of states that have enacted data broker registry laws.

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⁴ HB 2483 § 4.

⁵ HB 2483 § 7.



We respectfully request the Committee to decline to advance HB 2483 as proposed.

Thank you in advance for your consideration of this letter.

Sincerely,

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